

# Grace Okonkwo

Senior Infrastructure Engineer

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Infrastructure engineer with four years of focused experience building and maintaining developer tooling, CI/CD systems, and internal platforms that support engineering teams at scale. Proven track record deploying containerized applications, automating deployment workflows, and reducing build times for cross-functional teams. Strong foundation in cloud infrastructure, container orchestration, and observability. Seeking to deepen expertise in platform engineering and developer experience optimization.

## EXPERIENCE

### Senior Infrastructure Engineer, Meridian Systems | Remote | March 2024 – Present

Led the design and rollout of a new CI/CD platform serving 80+ engineers across four offices. Architected a GitLab Runner infrastructure on Kubernetes that reduced average build times from 18 minutes to 6 minutes, directly improving developer productivity and reducing cloud spend by approximately 35%. Managed the migration of legacy Jenkins pipelines to a modern declarative model, working closely with backend and frontend teams to ensure smooth transitions with minimal disruption. Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting using Prometheus and Grafana, establishing SLOs for build reliability and establishing a self-service observability dashboard that team leads could query independently. Documented infrastructure patterns and created runbooks that reduced MTTR for common incidents by 40%. Collaborated with security to enforce policy-as-code using OPA, embedding compliance checks into every deployment pipeline without adding measurable latency.

### Infrastructure Engineer, Vertex Data Solutions | Pittsburgh, PA | July 2022 – February 2024

Owned the container orchestration and deployment infrastructure supporting a team of 30 data engineers and analytics staff. Managed a multi-region EKS cluster on AWS, handling capacity planning, node autoscaling, and cost optimization across development, staging, and production environments. Automated infrastructure provisioning using Terraform, reducing manual setup time for new environments from two weeks to four hours and ensuring consistency across deployments. Built internal Helm charts and custom operators that allowed non-infrastructure engineers to deploy their applications without requiring deep Kubernetes knowledge, dramatically reducing onboarding friction. Maintained and upgraded etcd clusters, managed certificate rotation, and troubleshoot networking issues in containerized environments. Developed Python scripts to audit cloud resource usage and identify optimization opportunities, saving the company approximately \$150K annually in compute costs. Participated in on-call rotation, responding to infrastructure incidents and maintaining 99.5% uptime for the data platform used by 15 downstream business units.

### DevOps Engineer, Forge Platform | Pittsburgh, PA | January 2021 – June 2022

Joined a three-person platform team responsible for CI/CD, infrastructure provisioning, and developer tooling supporting 40 software engineers across two product teams. Implemented automated testing pipelines for both backend microservices and frontend applications, integrating unit tests, integration tests, and smoke tests into a single coherent deployment workflow. Deployed and maintained a private Docker registry with image scanning, vulnerability detection, and automated cleanup policies, reducing registry storage costs by 25%. Configured and managed Datadog monitoring across application and infrastructure layers, creating dashboards and alerts that gave engineers visibility into system behavior in production. Assisted with Kubernetes cluster upgrades and node OS patching, ensuring zero-downtime deployments. Wrote comprehensive documentation for developers on how to provision AWS resources safely using approved patterns, reducing misconfiguration incidents and security review cycles. Mentored two junior engineers on containerization best practices and infrastructure fundamentals, helping them transition from local development to production-like staging environments.

### Systems Administrator, Brightwell IT Services | Pittsburgh, PA | June 2019 – December 2020

Supported IT infrastructure for a managed services company serving 120+ small and mid-market clients. Managed Windows and Linux servers, administered Active Directory, configured backup and disaster recovery systems, and performed routine maintenance and patching. Triaged tickets across multiple client environments, prioritizing issues and coordinating with external vendors where needed. Documented runbooks for common procedures, improving incident response consistency. Gained foundational experience with virtualization, networking, and systems administration that informed later specialization in infrastructure automation.

## **SKILLS**

**Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS (EC2, EKS, S3, RDS, VPC), Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible

**CI/CD & Developer Tools:** GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Helm, ArgoCD, Jenkins, Datadog, Prometheus, Grafana

**Languages & Scripting:** Python, Bash, Go (basics), YAML

**Other:** Linux administration, etcd, PostgreSQL, Cost optimization, On-call incident response, Technical documentation

## **EDUCATION**

**Bachelor of Science in Computer Science**, University of Pittsburgh | Pittsburgh, PA | Graduated 2019